

CUNY AI LAB

Configuring skills and tools

New Media Lab · Room 7388.01
CUNY Graduate Center

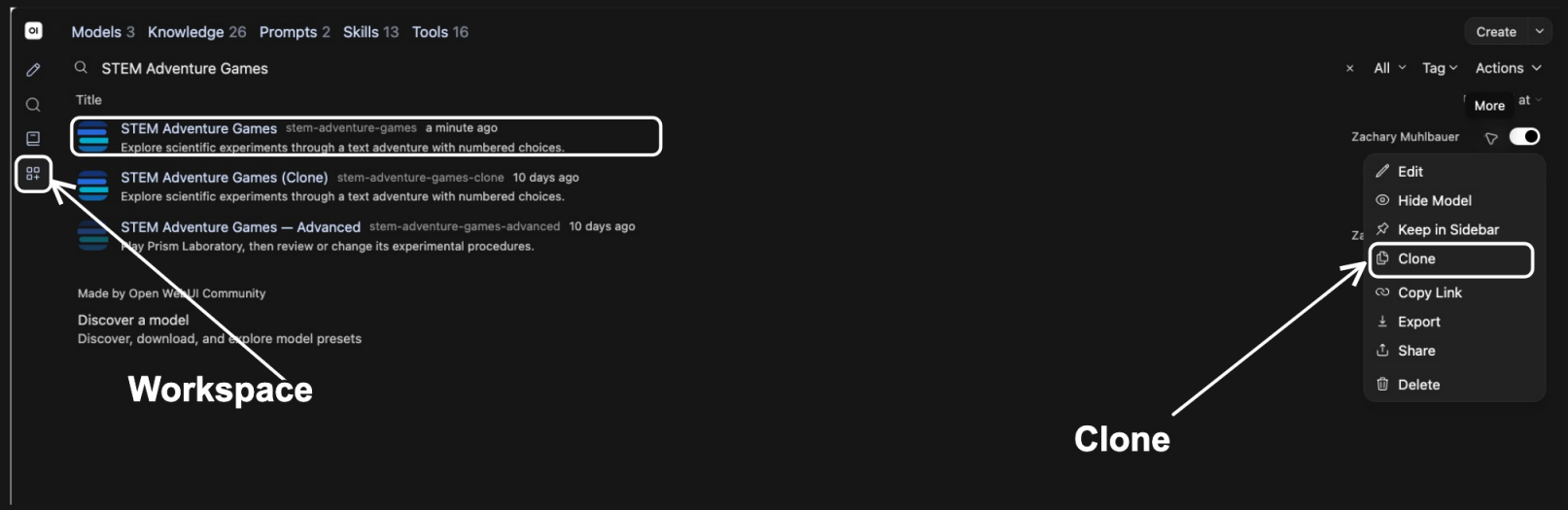
Thursday, October 15, 2026 · 2:30–4:00 p.m. Eastern

Developed by Zach Muhlbauer

https://cuny-ai-lab.github.io/sandbox-series/skills

Choose Your Own Adventure

1. Continue your saved model, or clone **STEM Adventure Games** in **Workspace → Models → ⋯ → Clone**
2. Open **Workspace → Models → Edit** and review your system prompt's setting, goals, and rules
3. Keep your model card open to add a skill and a tool



What Is a Skill?

Skills contain plain-text instructions for repeatable tasks

Trigger	Request or condition that starts a procedure
Procedure	Steps, checks, and points that require a question
Output	Required response content and form

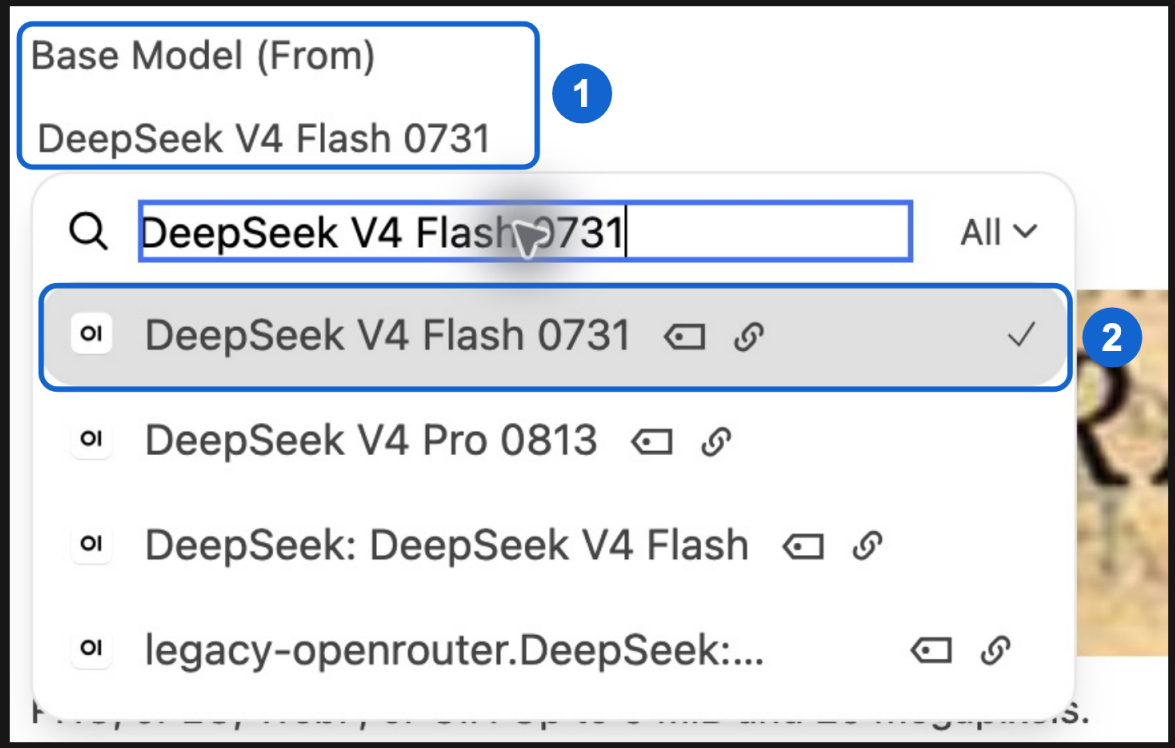
What Is a Tool?

When a model calls a **tool**, it is given the ability to execute a function and return its result, usually through a Python script

This is called **tool calling** (aka **function calling**)

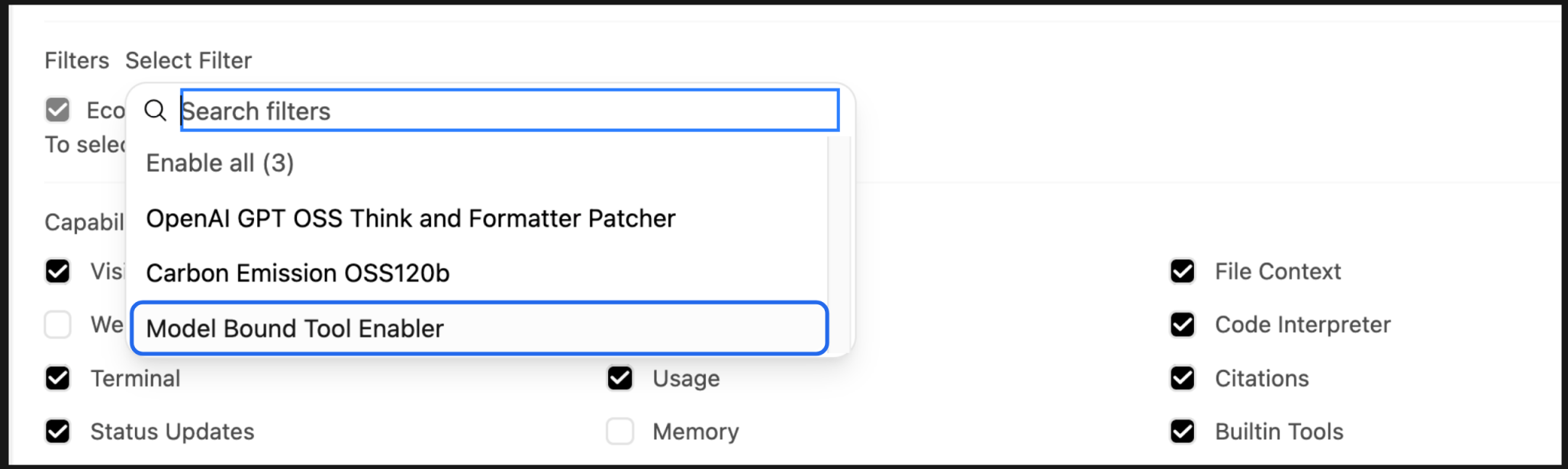
Input	Information passed to a function
Execution	Code that applies specified rules
Result	Returned output for a model to inspect

Update Model for Tool Calling



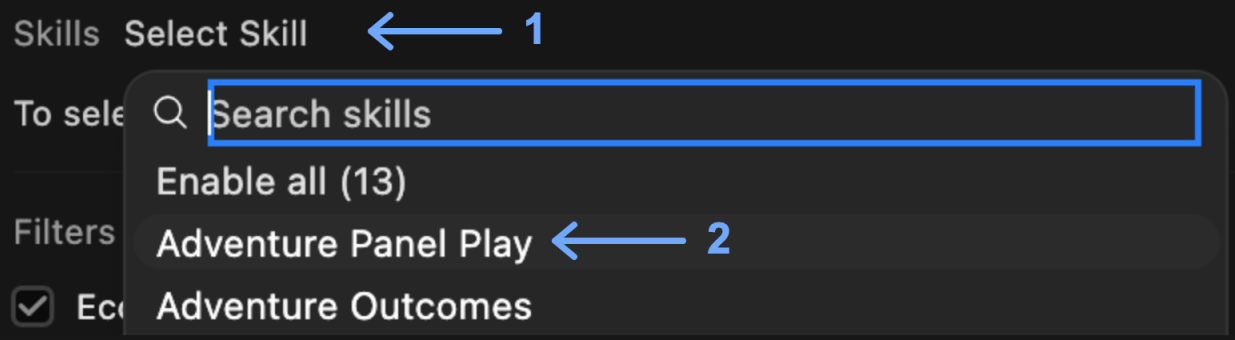
Enable Filter

Enable **Model Bound Tool Enabler** on your model card, which binds assigned tools to the model's operations.



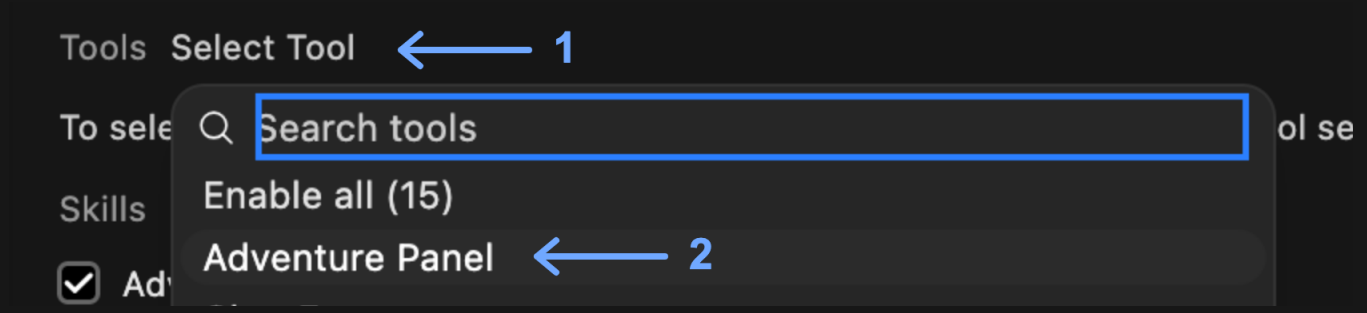
Add Your Skill

1. Open **Workspace → Models → Edit → Skills → Select Skill**
2. Choose **Adventure Panel Play** and read its saved instructions
3. Keep your model card open to add **Adventure Panel**



Add the 'Adventure Panel' tool

1. Open **Tools → Select Tool** on the same model card
2. Choose **Adventure Panel** and keep **Adventure Panel Play** selected
3. Add the system-prompt instructions on slide 10, then select **Save & Update**

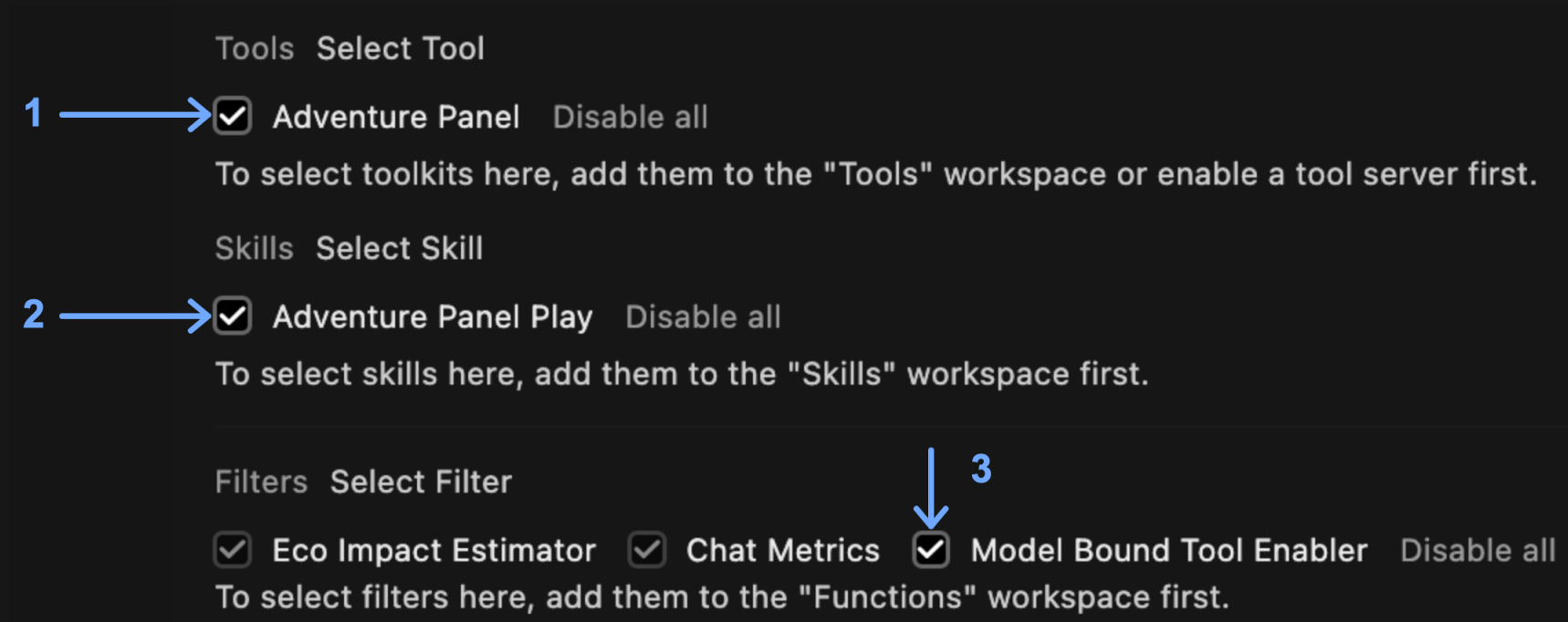


Model Card Check-In

Confirm these selections on your model card

1. **Adventure Panel** tool
2. **Adventure Panel Play** skill
3. **Model Bound Tool Enabler** filter

Keep your knowledge collection attached



Add Skill Instructions to the Bottom of Your System Prompt

Copy prompt

Load the attached Adventure Panel Play skill (extend-adventure-games) and follow it on every turn. Use show_scene from the Adventure Panel tool to display each scene and its choices. Follow this system prompt's setting, goals, rules, and source instructions.

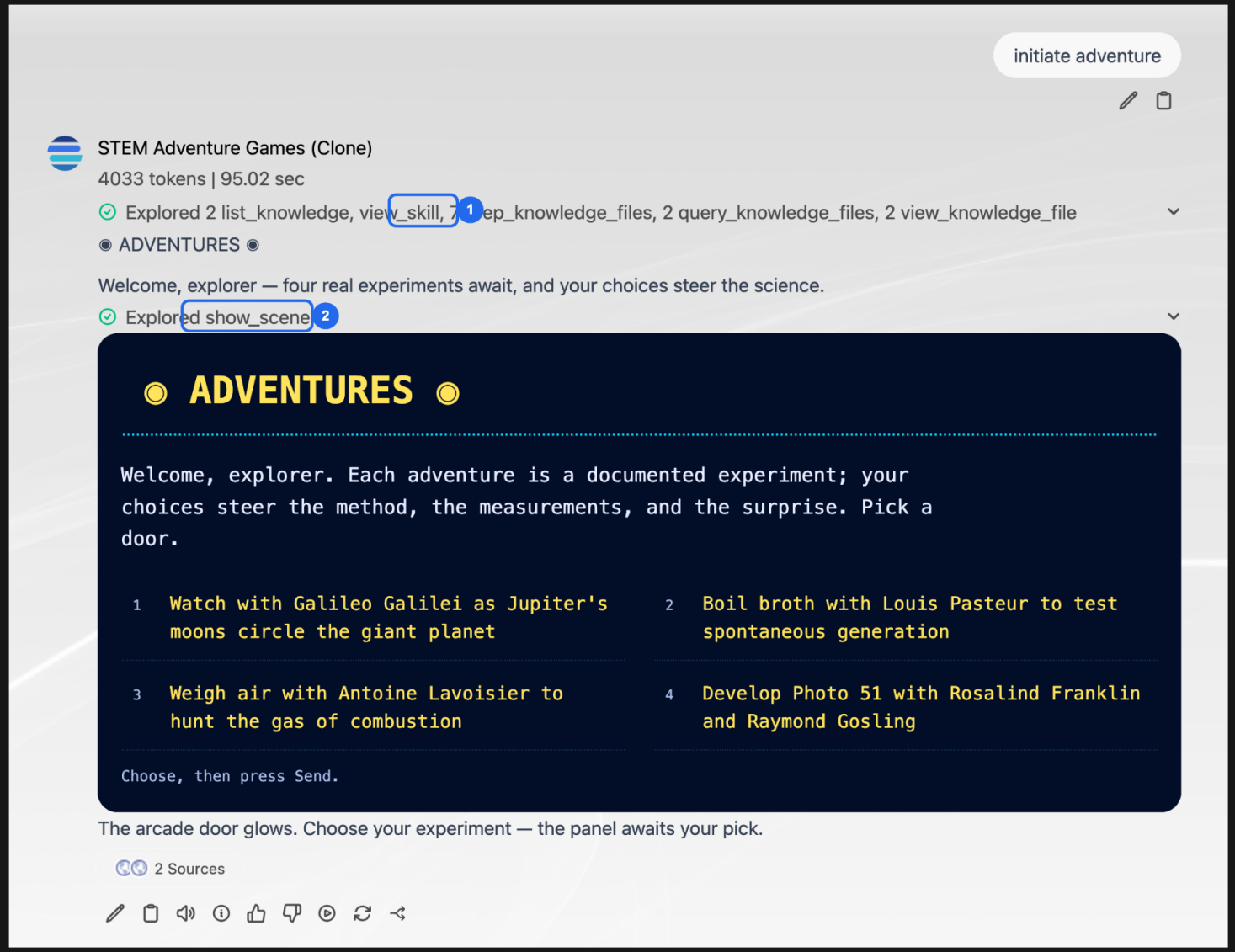
Test Your Adventure

1. Run your updated adventure game
2. Verify configured skill and tool are called appropriately
3. Then play the rest of your game

Observe Game Results

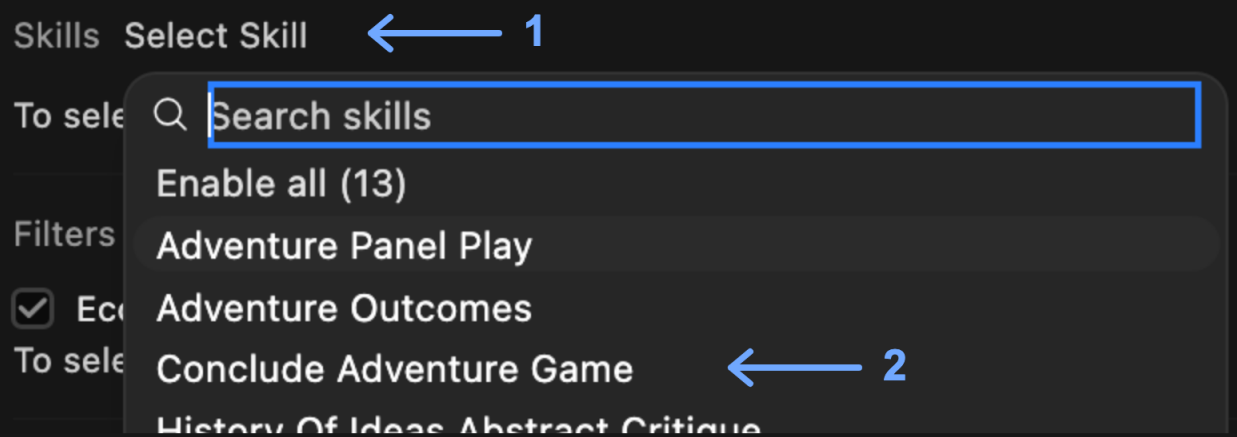
1. Check the **Adventure Panel Play** skill call
2. Check the **Adventure Panel** tool call

Open call details to confirm the skill and `show_scene` function



Explore Other Skills

1. Read **Adventure Outcomes** or **Conclude Adventure Game** after your first adventure works
2. Change one skill and save your model card
3. Run your adventure again and compare results



Choose Your Task

Revise One Item

1. Copy complete tool code or skill instructions
2. Describe an observed problem and one change

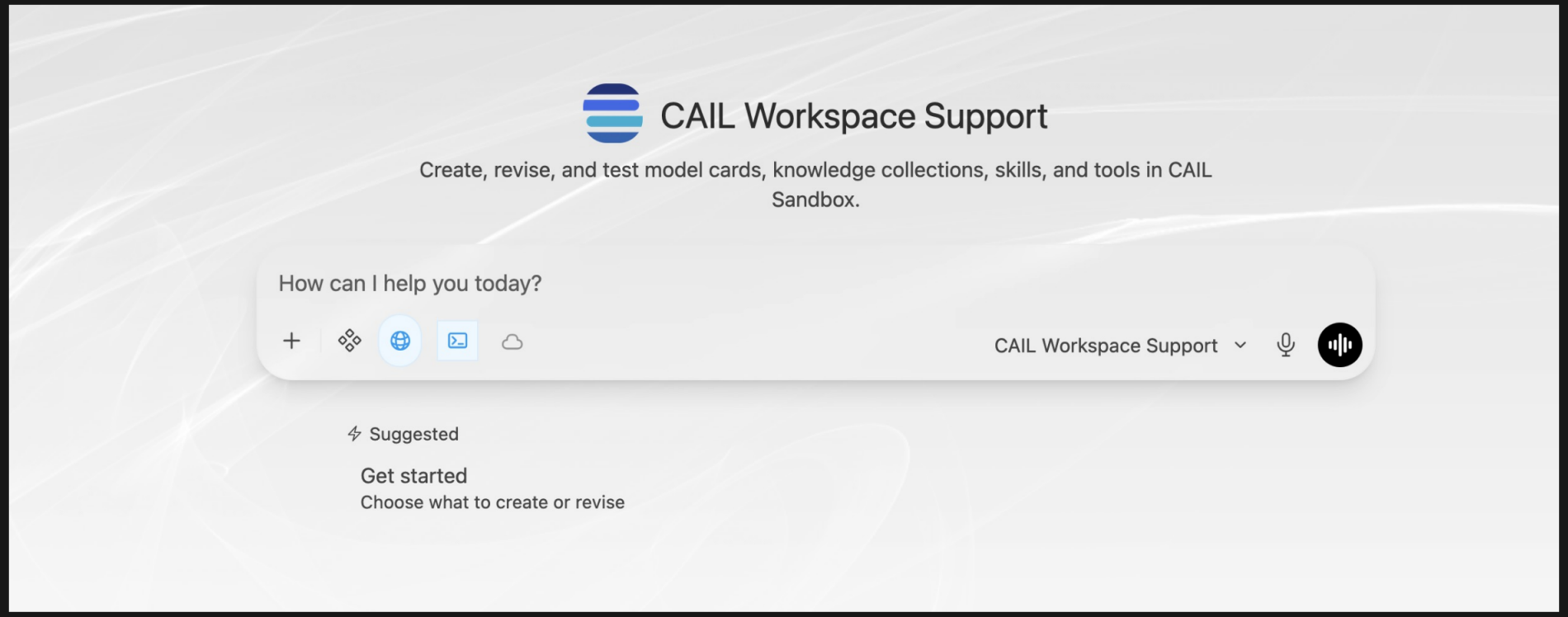
Copy tool code · Skill instructions

Create Your Own

1. Choose a task for your tool or skill
2. Specify its purpose, required input, and expected result

Work With Support

Prompt CAIL Workspace Support to generate a skill and/or tool that continues to support or further extends your adventure game, adapting an existing skill/tool or making your own.

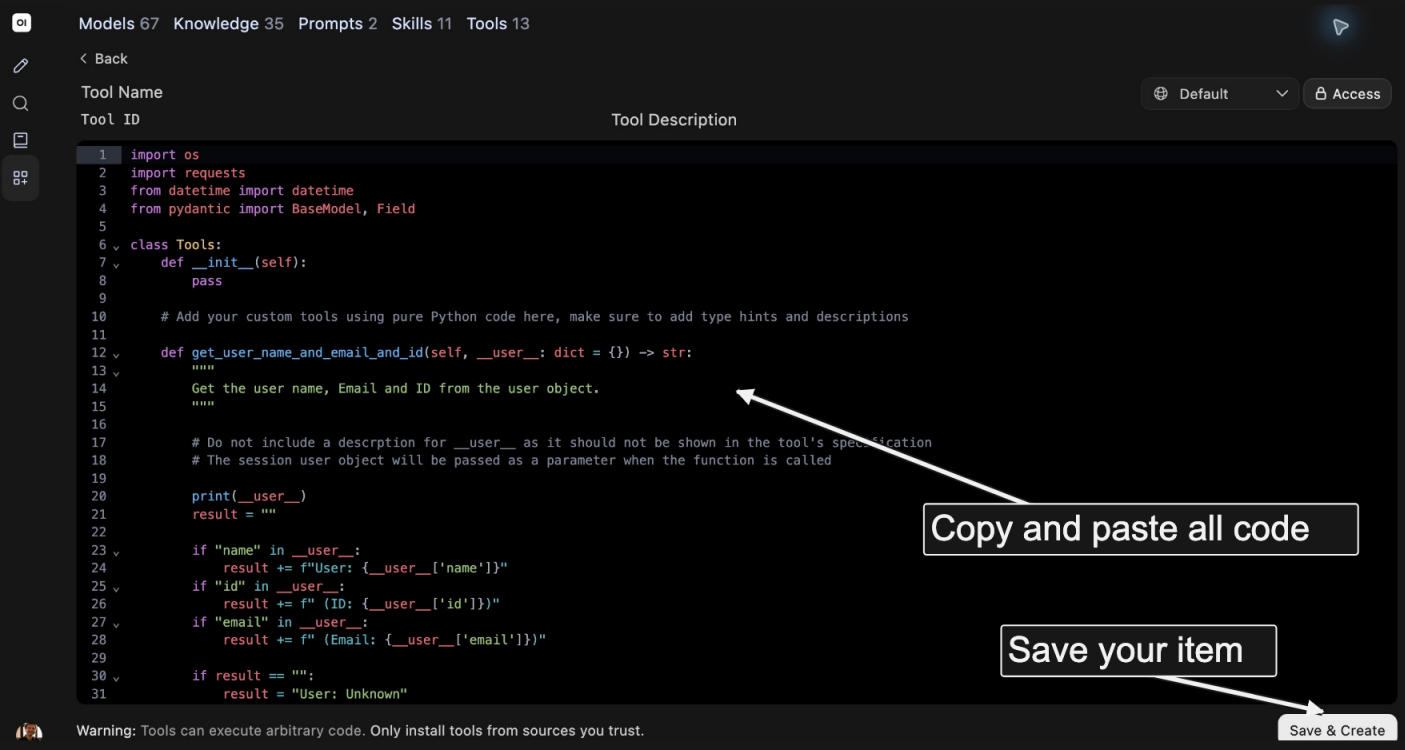


Adapt Your Adventure

1. Give **CAIL Workspace Support** your lesson plan, learning outcome, or disciplinary focus
2. Ask it to adapt or create a skill or tool that extends your adventure toward that outcome

Add Tools or Skills

1. Copy and paste all code for tools or plain text for skills, then save your item
2. On your model card, select your new tool or skill, and signpost it in your system prompt



Series Reflections

- What task in your teaching or research could benefit from a skill or tool?
- What would you develop next using the prompts, knowledge collections, skills, and tools you've explored?

Would you join us October 29, 2–4pm, to develop your adventure further and bring our games together in a collection that showcases the series?